

Sunday Dinner Menu

Serves 3 · Sunday 25 May 2026

- Fennel, Celery, and Herb Salad with Lemon Vinaigrette
- Chicken Stew with White Wine, Wings, and Gremolata
- Toasted Country Sourdough
- Orange Olive Oil Cake

Shopping List

Ingredient	Total	Salad	Stew	Bread	Cake
PROTEIN / MEAT					
Chicken thighs, boneless skinless	2 lb	—	2 lb	—	—
Chicken wings	1 lb	—	1 lb	—	—
Bacon	3 slices	—	3 slices	—	—
PRODUCE					
Carrots	4	—	4	—	—
Celery	4 stalks	3 stalks	1 rib	—	—
Fennel bulbs	2	2	—	—	—
Garlic	1 head	—	2 cloves	—	¼ clove (gremolata)
Lemons	2	2 tbsp juice	peel strip	—	½ tsp zest (gremolata)
Onion	1 medium	—	1 medium	—	—
Oranges	2	—	—	—	zest + ¼ cup juice
Parsley	1 large bunch	½ cup leaves	stems + 2 tbsp (gremolata)	—	—
Potatoes, small red	1 lb	—	1 lb	—	—
BREAD					
Sourdough loaf	1 large	—	—	1 large	—
PANTRY / DRY					
All-purpose flour	210 g + 2½ tbsp	—	2½ tbsp	—	210 g
Anchovy paste	2 tsp	—	2 tsp	—	—
Baking powder *	1½ tsp	—	—	—	1½ tsp
Bay leaf *	1	—	1	—	—
Dried thyme *	½ tsp	—	½ tsp	—	—
Powdered sugar *	for finish	—	—	—	finish
Sherry vinegar	1–2 tsp	—	1–2 tsp	—	—
Soy sauce *	1 tbsp	—	1 tbsp	—	—
Sugar	200 g	—	—	—	200 g
FRIDGE / DAIRY					
Butter, unsalted	57 g / 4 tbsp	—	57 g / 4 tbsp	—	—
Eggs	3	—	—	—	3
Milk, whole	120 ml / ½ cup	—	—	—	120 ml / ½ cup
Parmesan, shaved (optional)	30 g / 1 oz	30 g / 1 oz	—	—	—
OILS & LIQUIDS					
Chicken broth	5 cups / 1.2 L	—	5 cups / 1.2 L	—	—
Dry white wine	1 cup / 240 ml	—	1 cup / 240 ml	—	—
Extra-virgin olive oil	~320 ml / 1½ cups	60 ml / ¼ cup	—	splash	180 ml / ¾ cup
SEASONING					
Black pepper *	to taste	to taste	to taste	—	—
Diamond Crystal kosher salt *	see dishes	—	¾ tsp	—	½ tsp
Flaky salt *	to taste	—	—	to taste	—

* Pantry check — likely already in stock; confirm before shopping.

Parsley: buy a large bunch — one bunch covers salad leaves (½ cup), stew braise stems, and gremolata (2 tbsp). A small bunch will come up short on leaves.

Lemons: zest both before juicing. 2 lemons covers salad dressing juice, stew peel strip, and gremolata zest.

T-Minus Timeline

Time	Action
T-5 hr	Bake olive oil cake
T-3 hr	Prep all vegetables and salad components
T-2 hr 45 min	Begin stew — render bacon, brown wings
T-2 hr 05 min	Begin reduction phase
T-1 hr 35 min	Stew enters oven with wings, potatoes, early carrots
T-1 hr 05 min	Add thighs and remaining carrots
T-35 min	Begin raising oven to 400°F / 205°C — stew has ~15 min remaining
T-30 min	Make gremolata (max 30 min hold; discard and remake if longer)
T-20 min	Stew exits oven; season with vinegar and salt; hold uncovered
T-15 min	Toast bread once oven confirms 400°F / 205°C
T-5 min	Dress salad; final seasoning check on stew
T	Plate stew + gremolata; bread and salad to table. Serve immediately.

First failure if delayed: bread crust softens, then stew thickens. Dessert fully decoupled.

Workflow Notes

Critical path: wing browning → reduction → final thigh braise. Protect these above all else; bread and salad yield to stew timing. If timing slips: serve stew immediately, toast bread after plating, dress salad at table.

Oven sequence: Cake (350°F / 177°C) must complete before dinner. Stew owns oven at 325°F / 163°C. Raise to 400°F / 205°C at T-35; transition takes ~15–20 min. Bread enters only once temperature is confirmed. Dutch oven owns primary burner throughout stew.

Holding Chain

Component	Hold Strategy	Max Hold	Drift	Corrective
Stew	Dutch oven, uncovered, off heat	20 min	Thickens	Loosen with hot broth
Salad	Undressed, refrigerated	2 hr	Softens once dressed	Dress only before service
Bread	Loose rack hold	15 min	Crust softens	Re-toast 3–4 min
Cake	Room temp, uncovered	8 hr	Minimal drift	None
Gremolata	Small bowl, uncovered	30 min	Zest dulls; garlic sharpens	Discard and remake

Fennel, Celery, and Herb Salad

Serves 6–8 · 20 min active · No cook

Raw fennel, celery, and parsley against the stew’s soft profile — crunch, freshness, and acid.

Ingredients

Ingredient	Amount
Fennel bulbs, shaved thin	2
Celery stalks, sliced thinly	3
Parsley leaves	½ cup
Lemon juice	2 tbsp
Extra-virgin olive oil	60 ml / ¼ cup
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	to taste
Black pepper	to taste
Shaved Parmesan (optional)	30 g / 1 oz

Prep

- Shave fennel thinly. Slice celery thinly. Refrigerate until service.

Assembly

- Whisk lemon juice + olive oil + salt + pepper vigorously. Broken vinaigrette is intentional.
- Dress immediately before serving. Toss with parsley. Add Parmesan at final toss if using.

Adjust: increase lemon if stew is especially rich. Adjust salt after adding Parmesan.

CCPs

Severity	Failure Mode & Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Dressing too early — fennel softens and releases water	Unrecoverable for texture; salad remains edible

Toasted Country Sourdough

Serves 6–8 · 5 min active · Oven: 400°F / 205°C after stew exits

Ingredients

Ingredient	Amount
Sourdough loaf	1 large
Olive oil	as needed
Flaky salt	to taste

Method

- Slice thickly. Brush with olive oil.
- Wait for oven to confirm 400°F / 205°C before bread enters. Toast 8–10 min.
- Cue: edges crisp and browned; centre yields under firm pressure without feeling rigid.
- Hold on loose rack up to 15 min. Re-toast 3–4 min if crust softens.

CCPs

Severity	Failure Mode & Sensory Cue	Recovery
Minor	Overtoasting — deep brown edges, rigid centre	Partially recoverable with extra olive oil. Reduce time next batch.

Chicken Stew with White Wine, Wings, and Gremolata

Yield: 6–8 · Total: ~2 hr 45 min · Active: ~50 min · Oven: 325°F / 163°C

Deep chicken flavor through browned wings, staged reduction, and oven braising. Gremolata and sherry vinegar restore brightness at service. The reduction phase is essential — do not shorten it.

Ingredients

Ingredient	Amount
Stew	
Chicken thighs, boneless skinless, halved crosswise	2 lb
Chicken wings, separated at joints	1 lb
Bacon, chopped	3 slices
Onion, finely chopped	1 medium
Celery rib, minced	1
Garlic cloves, minced	2
Anchovy paste	2 tsp
Dried thyme	½ tsp
Bay leaf	1
Parsley stems	from 1 small bunch
Lemon peel strip	1 thin (~2 in / 5 cm)
Chicken broth	5 cups / 1.2 L
Dry white wine	1 cup / 240 ml
Soy sauce	1 tbsp
Unsalted butter	57 g / 4 tbsp
All-purpose flour	2½ tbsp
Small red potatoes, quartered	1 lb
Carrots, cut into ½-inch pieces, divided	4
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	¾ tsp
Black pepper	to taste
Finish	
Sherry vinegar	1–2 tsp
Gremolata	
Parsley, finely chopped	2 tbsp
Lemon zest	½ tsp
Garlic clove, microplaned	¼ small

Prep

1. Heat oven to 325°F / 163°C.
2. Pat wings dry thoroughly.
3. Season thighs with ¾ tsp Diamond Crystal kosher salt + black pepper. Temper 15–20 min.
4. Divide carrots into two equal portions.

Active Cooking

Critical path: wing browning → reduction → final braise.

Phase 1 — Render Bacon and Brown Wings

1. Cook bacon over medium-low until browned, 6–8 min. Transfer to bowl.
2. Increase to medium. Brown wings deeply 10–12 min total. Brown in batches if necessary.
3. Cue: deep golden brown, crisped edges, dark fond on pot. Transfer wings and bacon to bowl. Hold room temp up to 30 min.

Phase 2 — Build and Reduce Base

1. Add onion, celery, garlic, anchovy paste, thyme. Cook 3–5 min.
2. Add wine, 1 cup / 240 ml broth, soy sauce. Scrape up all browned bits.
3. Add bay leaf, parsley stems, lemon peel.
4. Boil aggressively until nearly dry, 12–15 min. Cue: vegetables begin lightly frying in concentrated fat. Do not stop early.

Phase 3 — Build Stew

1. Reduce to medium-low. Stir in butter. Add flour; cook 1 min, stirring continuously.

2. Gradually whisk in remaining 4 cups / 960 ml broth until smooth.
3. Add wings, bacon, potatoes, and first half of carrots. Bring to simmer.
4. Transfer uncovered to oven for 30 min.

Phase 4 — Add Thighs

1. Remove from oven. Scrape fond above liquid line back into stew.
2. Add thighs and remaining carrots. Return uncovered to oven for 40–50 min.
3. No pull temperature — thighs remain submerged to service.
4. Primary cue: paring knife slides through thickest thigh with no drag on entry or exit. If resistance remains: 10 more min.
5. Observation: late carrots should remain intact while tender.

Holding & Assembly

1. During final 30 min: make gremolata in small uncovered bowl. Max hold 30 min; discard and remake if longer.
2. Remove and discard bay leaf, parsley stems, lemon peel.
3. Remove wings; reclaim meat from flats and drumettes. Discard bones, skin, cartilage. Return meat to stew.
4. Stir in 1–2 tsp sherry vinegar. Taste after first teaspoon.
5. Adjust salt and pepper.
6. Hold uncovered off heat up to 20 min. Loosen with hot broth if stew thickens.
7. Serve with ~½ tsp gremolata per bowl.

Adjust: add second tsp vinegar only if stew still tastes heavy. Thin with hot broth if over-thickened. Increase gremolata to brighten a dense bowl.

CCPs

Severity	Failure Mode & Sensory Cue	Recovery
Critical	Incomplete reduction — vegetables still floating in abundant liquid with no sizzle	Continue reducing until vegetables lightly fry in fat
Major	Advancing with pale wings and weak fond — wings pale with little fond on pot	Continue browning before proceeding to Phase 2
Major	Over-thickened stew — coats spoon heavily like gravy	Thin gradually with hot broth
Major	Overcooked late carrots — collapsing at edges	Carrot texture lost; stew remains acceptable
Minor	Excess gremolata — lemon/garlic dominates aroma	Reduce garnish on remaining bowls

Orange Olive Oil Cake

One 9-inch cake · Serves 8 · Active: 20 min · Oven: 350°F / 177°C · Bake before dinner
Citrus lift and restrained sweetness to close the meal; soft crumb contrasts the crisp bread and gremolata earlier.

Ingredients

Ingredient	Amount
Sugar	200 g
Orange zest	zest of 2 oranges
Eggs	3
Extra-virgin olive oil	180 ml / ¾ cup
Whole milk	120 ml / ½ cup
Orange juice	60 ml / ¼ cup
All-purpose flour (weight authoritative)	210 g
Baking powder	1½ tsp
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	½ tsp
Powdered sugar	for finish

Method

1. Heat oven to 350°F / 177°C. Grease 9-inch cake pan.
 2. Rub orange zest into sugar. Whisk in eggs.
 3. Add olive oil, milk, and orange juice.
 4. Fold in flour, baking powder, and salt. Do not overmix.
 5. Bake 40–50 min. Cue: centre springs back lightly; skewer with moist crumbs, no wet batter. Continue in 5-min increments if wet batter remains.
 6. Cool 20 min before unmolding. If cake resists: return to pan, cool 10 min more.
 7. Hold uncovered at room temp up to 8 hr. Serve with light powdered sugar.
- Adjust: reduce powdered sugar if serving after wine. Add fresh zest at serving for more citrus aroma.

CCPs

Severity	Failure Mode & Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Underbaked centre — wet batter on skewer	Continue baking in 5-minute increments
Minor	Excess mixing — batter becomes thick and elastic	Fold minimally; stop once flour is just incorporated